

Chapter 30-2

Liang Shi wiped her sweat and went to the bathroom.

Her body had been aroused with desire but had found no relief. She spent a slightly longer time in the bathroom, taking the opportunity to calm her emotions. When she stood up again, her legs were still somewhat weak, desperately craving to do something.

She turned on the faucet, adjusting the water temperature to the coldest setting, washing away the dampness from her palms before splashing water on her face.

Her thoughts finally returned to rationality.

The cold water didn't completely wash away the flush from her face, and her ears still retained traces of having been moved to passion.

Looking at herself in the mirror, Liang Shi couldn't help but smile bitterly.

What was the point?

She'd be a pig if she did this kind of thing again!

Xu Qingzhu was maintaining her chaste composure, feeling at ease with her, but what about herself?

She had been stirred to the point of not knowing what to do, yet couldn't do anything about it.

Liang Shi immediately decided that in the future, if she wanted to watch movies, she would definitely go to the cinema and watch animated films.

Absolutely no romantic films.

And also, suspense films.

What the hell was that?

Why did suspense films all have such large scales?

This wasn't scientific.

After Liang Shi's mood had calmed down somewhat, she unconsciously scratched her hand again. The dense red rash on her hand seemed to be reminding her—she was having an allergic reaction.

Liang Shi rolled up her pajama sleeves and discovered that her arms were also covered in dense red bumps, to a degree that would frighten people with trypophobia¹.

Even the area below her collarbone had them, though not as densely packed as on her arms and hands.

These small red bumps were itchy. Initially they didn't hurt, but now that she had been scratching them for so long, that patch of skin was stinging.

Liang Shi frowned, thinking about what she had eaten that day.

She herself was allergic to green peppers, so she never touched them.

After eating green peppers, she would have a similar reaction, so she suspected whether she had inadvertently consumed green peppers.

But she quickly recalled everything she had eaten throughout the day—no green peppers.

So she suspected it was the water in the swimming pool that evening that had caused her allergic reaction.

Some swimming pools had unclean water sources, or the water was too cold, which could also cause allergies.

Liang Shi planned to apply some ointment and observe. If she still had these symptoms tomorrow, she would go to the hospital.

Generally speaking, her body's self-healing mechanism was quite good. When she had allergic reactions to green peppers before, she had many more red bumps on her body, even on her face, but they would all disappear after a night's sleep.

It was late now, and she didn't want to disturb others.

Because her hands felt burning, she turned on the cold water again and rinsed her hands.

After drying her hands, she walked out of the bathroom, only to see Xu Qingzhu leaning against the door, raising three curved fingers, about to knock.

Liang Shi stepped back half a step, maintaining a safe distance from her, then stepped sideways to exit.

Xu Qingzhu looked her up and down, saying in a low voice, "Your sleeves are wet."

Her voice was cool and clear, the casually spoken words ending with a hint of charm. Though it was just a simple sentence, it made Liang Shi's heart race.

Liang Shi coughed softly, "I washed my hands."

Although the two now slept in the same bed, they maintained a guarded state. Xu Qingzhu wore long pants and long sleeves to sleep every day, sometimes even wearing socks, claiming it was for warmth.

Liang Shi, afraid that Xu Qingzhu would think she had ulterior motives, also wore long pants and long sleeves daily, even though she personally preferred wearing nightgowns.

But occasionally she had nightmares and her sleeping position wouldn't be as usual. A nightgown might ride up, and if she kicked off the covers because of heat, it would be hard to explain whether she had intentionally exposed herself for Xu Qingzhu to see.

To avoid misunderstandings, she solved the problem at its source.

Today Xu Qingzhu's pajamas were gray, while hers were black and white striped.

Both were silk pajamas with good stretch and very smooth fabric, but inconvenient when washing up. Even when rolled up, they would fall down and get wet with the slightest big movement.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes casually swept over her from top to bottom, her gaze settling on her hands, "You washed for quite a while."

The words carried an ambiguous undertone.

Liang Shi coughed softly, pretending to be composed, "It was... alright."

She said this while stepping sideways out of the bathroom, "Go ahead."

Xu Qingzhu said, "I'm not going in."

Liang Shi: "Hm?"

"Then you came looking for me for something?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "Yes, the power went out downstairs. You need to get someone to fix it, or everything in the refrigerator will spoil by tomorrow."

"Okay." Liang Shi readily agreed, but then paused, "Were you waiting outside the door for me for a long time?"

Xu Qingzhu thought about it, glancing at the clock on the wall, "Not too long, three minutes."

Liang Shi: "Oh."

That was good then.

"Mainly, I didn't dare knock on the door." Xu Qingzhu said casually, "I was afraid you were doing something and I would interrupt."

"What could I be doing?" Liang Shi said while calling the butler, "I was just using the toilet."

"Only you would know that." Xu Qingzhu shrugged indifferently, pulling open the door to leave, "After all, your sleeves are wet."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi unconsciously followed her lead and replied, "If I was really doing something, three minutes wouldn't be enough to finish."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow, her cool, clear gaze sweeping over her face, then her neck, before stopping at her hands.

Liang Shi instinctively pulled her hands behind her back and defended herself, "I mean, I was just simply using the toilet, I didn't do anything."

Xu Qingzhu drew out her voice: "Oh~"

Slightly sarcastic.

Liang Shi coughed softly and explained seriously, "What we just watched was just an ordinary movie, right? Could I really do something because of it? I wasn't affected at all."

By the end, even she felt guilty, but still pretended to be calm.

She couldn't back down.

Xu Qingzhu nodded perfunctorily, "Right, you're very impressive."

"Exactly." Seeing her perfunctory expression, Liang Shi couldn't help but defend herself, "No, you have to believe me."

Xu Qingzhu: "I do believe you. I didn't say anything, did I?"

Liang Shi: "..."

You didn't say anything.

But your eyes clearly conveyed—you definitely did something unspeakable and unbroadcastable in that bathroom just now.

Liang Shi had never suffered such humiliation in her life. She said in exasperation, "I'm not a three-minute person!"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Without thinking, she unconsciously replied, "Then how many minutes are you?"

Liang Shi: "..."

The atmosphere instantly became awkward.

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, embarrassed to the point where her soul nearly flew away.

Xu Qingzhu coughed softly. She was about to say, "Actually, I don't really want to know," but after saying just two words, Liang Shi, who had always been easygoing and often compromised on various matters in the first half of her life, didn't retreat at all. Instead, she said stubbornly with a tense face, "I'll try it next time and tell you."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She turned her face away, "We'll talk about it later."

Liang Shi fell silent.

She was thinking, was there any river she could jump into to cool down?

Footnotes:

- 1. 密集恐懼症 (**Trypophobia**) - A fear or aversion to clusters of small holes or bumps, which can cause discomfort or anxiety in some people when viewing densely packed patterns.

Author's Note: This appears to be part of a larger narrative involving characters in an ABO (Alpha/Beta/Omega) alternate universe romance setting, continuing the tension and misunderstandings between the main characters.